湖南文理学院

# On the Teaching of Self-directed Reading Texts

## A Case Study of Units 2 & 4, Grade 8 Chinese Textbook

Presenter: Zhang San

Supervisor: Prof. Li Si

School of Literature, Hunan University of Arts and Science

June 2025

# Contents

1. Background and Significance
2. Contents and Methods
3. Strategies and Practice
4. Conclusion and Outlook

Section 1

# Background and Significance



# Contents

1. Background and Significance
   - Research Background
   - Significance
2. Contents and Methods
3. Strategies and Practice
4. Conclusion and Outlook

# Research Background

## Policy Context

- The unified Chinese textbook builds a tripartite reading system: *guided reading — self-directed reading — extensive reading*;
- Self-directed texts bridge teacher guidance and autonomous reading;
- The curriculum standards emphasize independent reading competence.

## Practical Dilemmas

- Self-directed texts are often taught exactly like guided ones;
- Students' agency is weak, and strategy transfer stays limited.

# Significance

## Theoretical Value

- Enriches research on self-directed text teaching;
- Grounds the tripartite reading system in practice.

## Practical Value

- Offers actionable strategies for frontline teachers;
- Fosters autonomous construction of reading ability.

Cf. *Chinese Curriculum Standards for Compulsory Education (2022)* [1].

Section 2

# Contents and Methods

# Contents

1. Background and Significance

2. Contents and Methods
   - Research Contents
   - Methods
   - Data Analysis Example

3. Strategies and Practice

4. Conclusion and Outlook

# Research Contents

- Analyze the arrangement of self-directed texts in Units 2 and 4;

## Key Concept

*Self-directed text*: text types read mainly autonomously, with the teacher acting as a facilitator, emphasizing the transfer of reading strategies [3].

## Research Contents

- Analyze the arrangement of self-directed texts in Units 2 and 4;
- Investigate current teaching practices and problems;

### Key Concept

*Self-directed text*: text types read mainly autonomously, with the teacher acting as a facilitator, emphasizing the transfer of reading strategies [3].

## Research Contents

- Analyze the arrangement of self-directed texts in Units 2 and 4;
- Investigate current teaching practices and problems;
- Propose principles and strategies for self-directed text teaching;

### Key Concept

*Self-directed text*: text types read mainly autonomously, with the teacher acting as a facilitator, emphasizing the transfer of reading strategies [3].

## Research Contents

- Analyze the arrangement of self-directed texts in Units 2 and 4;
- Investigate current teaching practices and problems;
- Propose principles and strategies for self-directed text teaching;
- Design lesson cases and reflect on classroom practice.

### Key Concept

*Self-directed text*: text types read mainly autonomously, with the teacher acting as a facilitator, emphasizing the transfer of reading strategies [3].

# Research Methods

Table 1: Overview of research methods

| Method | Sample | Purpose |
|---|---|---|
| Literature review | 42 journal papers | Map the research field |
| Questionnaire | 320 participants | Profile current practice |
| Classroom observation | 12 lessons | Analyze teaching behavior |
| Case analysis | 6 lesson designs | Distill practical strategies |

# Data Analysis Example

## Survey statistics (excerpt)

Class-level means of reading self-efficacy ($n = 320$):

$$\bar{X} = \frac{1}{n}\sum_{i=1}^{n} x_i, \qquad S = \sqrt{\frac{1}{n-1}\sum_{i=1}^{n}(x_i - \bar{X})^2} \tag{1}$$

Pre-post differences are examined with paired $t$-tests[2].

## Analysis script (excerpt)

```
import pandas as pd
data = pd.read_excel("reading_survey.xlsx")
mean, std = data["score"].mean(), data["score"].std()
print(f"mean = {mean:.2f}, std = {std:.2f}")
```

## Section 3

# Strategies and Practice



# Contents

1. Background and Significance

2. Contents and Methods

3. Strategies and Practice
   - Teaching Principles
   - Lesson Design
   - Practical Effects

4. Conclusion and Outlook

# Principles of Self-directed Text Teaching

1. **Student agency** — give classroom time back to readers;
2. **Strategy transfer** — reuse strategies from guided reading;
3. **Assessment-driven** — task sheets and reading logs as engines;
4. **Integration** — link in-class self-directed reading with extensive reading.

## Side notes as scaffolding

The side notes in self-directed texts provide thinking scaffolds; teachers should help students *learn to ask questions* with them until independent reading is achieved.

# Lesson Design: *Return of the Wild Geese*

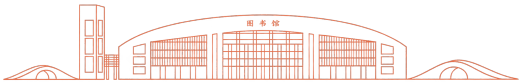



Fig.: Library of HUAS (illustrative material)

| | |
|---|---|
| Lead-in | Short video on bird migration; |
| Reading | Task sheet with side notes; |
| Sharing | Group reports and peer questioning; |
| Transfer | Comparative reading of another text; |
| Homework | A 300-word observation note. |

# Practical Effects

## Classroom observation

- Independent reading time rose from 8 to 18 minutes per lesson;
- Student-initiated questions grew from 21% to 57%;
- Completion rate of strategy-transfer tasks increased by 32%.

## A caveat

Self-directed does not mean “hands-off”: teacher feedback remains the guarantee of reading quality.

Section 4

# Conclusion and Outlook



# Contents

1. Background and Significance
2. Contents and Methods
3. Strategies and Practice
4. Conclusion and Outlook

# Conclusion and Outlook

## Conclusions

- Self-directed text teaching should return to autonomous reading;
- Task sheets + side-note scaffolds + comparative reading work well;
- Integrated design of the tripartite reading system deserves study.

## Future work

- Quasi-experimental studies with larger samples;
- IT-supported assessment of self-directed classrooms.

# References I

[1] □□□□□□□□□□.
□□□□□□□□□□□□*2022*□□□.
□□□□□□□□□□, □□, 2022.

[2] □□□.
□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□.
□□□□□□□, 5:18–23, 2021.

[3] □□□.
□□□□□□□□□□□□□□.
□□□□□, 7:4–10, 2019.

# Thank You!

Q & A

Hunan University of Arts and Science

